

EVALUATION OF CHILDREN'S RIGHTS IN EDUCATION AND HEALTH IN THE INDIGENOUS COMMUNITY

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Rationale for the Project

In this research, the aim is to highlight the context of indigenous communities, analyzing the enactment of children's rights in the Tének community.

The problem has been identified that children's rights are not always met in terms of attending school or medical checks due to difficulties with access. However, the experiences of the community are not always taken into account in order to meet their specific needs.

The aim is to analyze the experiences of children in the Tének community of Xolol, Municipality of San Antonio, S.L.P., because the situation of children in first nations peoples, as is well documented, continues to be a topic that is not prioritized.

Description of the community

The Community of Xolol, belongs to the municipality of San Antonio, S.L.P.: To get to the community from San Antonio, one takes the road towards Tanlajás, but first one must make a diversion to the crossing of Tanjaj nec, and from there one gets directly to the community.

the community has 300 inhabitants, including children, young people, adults and the elderly. While most of the community speak Spanish as a second language, the principal language is Tének, which is the mother tongue spoken by people of all ages in the community. This language, huasteco or Teenek/Tének, belongs to the mayan language family.

Objective

Evaluate the impact of children's rights on education and health in indigenous communities in Xolol en the municipality of San Antonio S.L.P.

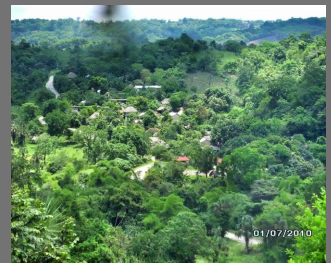
Resultados

A survey was undertaken with 25 people in the community, including 2 teachers, a doctor, a nurse. The survey was delivered orally so that respondents could expand on their answers. 16 parents stated that it was important for their children to attend school, but most also commented on the important learning that can happen through activities in the home or in the fields alongside the family. 10 parents added that they needed a teacher who could speak the Tének language, and that there was better access to the internet, and also that the teachers could work more closely with the parents.

In the case of health care, the parents commented that in order to receive social care support, they were obliged to attend medical checks every month. However, they would prefer to be able to get their health care from elders in the community, who offer alternative medicine based on natural and herbal remedies.

Conclusiones

Children's rights rely on various processes which make it possible to guarantee and protect human rights. The state plays a key role in ensuring these needs are met, however, it is essential to recognize that the context of an indigenous community gives rise to differences that should be highlighted. Formal education is important to parents, but they also know that knowledge that can be derived through informal learning in the home and in the field, where children learn skills that are relevant for life in the community. Moreover, having access to teaching in their mother tongue is another aspect of granting the linguistic rights of the community. There was also a clear message that alternative medicine should be recognised alongside state health provision. These aspects would provide an appropriate setting in which children's rights could be better met by the state.



Comunidad de Xolol con fecha 01 de julio del 2010, Imagen tomada del Sitio de Facebook Xolol San Antonio

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